
NCCA ENTERTAINMENT PRESENTS
PAPER TAGS
A crime thriller with a mother's heart
Written by Kelly R. Tenney

The premise

Original feature screenplay

A Black Atlanta detective investigating a young musician’s murder turns to the ex-lover she once imprisoned. When the stolen-car ring leads to her mentor and her teenage nephew, she must expose her own mistakes to save her family.

She needs her ex to be guilty. She needs her mentor to be good.

The story

An investigation becomes a fight for her family

THE CASE

Malik Boyd dies with a stolen-car programmer in his hand. Tasha recognizes Dre’s craftsmanship and signs him as her informant.

THE BETRAYAL

Forged impound releases lead to Captain Delgado. Jalen is already inside the ring. Tasha takes the truth to federal agents, then walks into a dockside trap.

Tasha Monroe

The lead role

WHAT SHE WANTS

Find Malik’s killer. Protect Jalen. Prove that her judgment, and the career built on it, still deserve trust.

WHAT SHE MUST FACE

Her certainty has become a blind spot. Saving her family means confessing her misconduct and refusing the lie that could protect her badge.

Dre Coleman

The former lover she arrested

THE MAN SHE REMEMBERS

A gifted mechanic with an easy smile and a criminal past. He knows how cars disappear and how Tasha hides what hurts.

THE MAN SHE MUST TRUST

He took blame beyond his own crimes to protect her. His attempt to shield Jalen fails. Their second chance begins when he gives her the truth.

Captain Ray Delgado

The mentor who controls the paperwork

THE PUBLIC FACE

A paternal captain who knows her coffee, praises her work, and treats her nephew like family.

THE PRIVATE MACHINE

His approvals move stolen cars through impound into export. His kindness keeps Tasha loyal. At the dock, he offers her safety in exchange for one final lie.

Jalen and Lorraine

The human cost of the case

JALEN MONROE

Seventeen. His father’s toolbox offers a connection to the man he lost. Roman turns a damaged car and a recorded theft into a debt Jalen cannot escape.

LORRAINE BOYD

Malik’s mother refuses easy reassurance. His unfinished bass line keeps the loss present and forces Tasha to answer honestly.

Atlanta to Savannah

A world built from work, family, and borrowed trust

Rain on Peachtree. Breakfast at Waffle House. A body shop on Hollowell. A guardian’s kitchen.

The investigation follows the cars to Savannah, where container aisles turn a familiar police operation into a family rescue.

Warm interiors. Cold steel. Amber dock lights.

Tone and visual language

Grounded crime thriller with romantic and family stakes

THE THRILLER

A taped glove. Forged releases. A blue GPS dot. Each discovery threatens someone Tasha already loves.

THE EMOTION

A worn ring, a missing pry bar, an unfinished song, and a restored Charger carry the story’s grief and possibility.

Audience and positioning

NCCA development targets

Primary target: Lifetime
Secondary target: BET+
Additional targets: ALLBLK, TV One, and streaming crime slates

Core audience: women 25–54, with crossover to crime-thriller and family-drama viewers.

Comparable energy: Training Day’s corrupt mentor, with a female lead and intimate family jeopardy.

Lead casting suggestions

Development wish list. No actors attached.

TASHA MONROE

Meagan Good
Tika Sumpter
Nicole Beharie

DRE COLEMAN

Trevante Rhodes
Jay Ellis
Sinqua Walls

Casting priority: attach Tasha, then test the Tasha–Dre chemistry.

No approaches made per supplied casting list. Interest, availability, and pricing unverified.

Supporting casting suggestions

Top pick / alternate / wild card, in the supplied order

CAPT. DELGADO	Giancarlo Esposito / Jimmy Smits / Esai Morales
AGENT KELLER	Sonja Sohn / Gina Torres / Roselyn Sanchez
JALEN MONROE	Caleb McLaughlin / Jaden Michael / Isaiah Russell-Bailey
LORRAINE BOYD	Loretta Devine / Tichina Arnold / Kim Fields

All names are suggestions only. No attachments or verified availability.

Production approach

Character scenes carry the film. The port supplies the escalation.

THE CORE LOCATIONS

Home, body shop, police offices, club, and federal meeting room. Atlanta texture supports the central relationships.

THE SET PIECE

A concentrated Savannah dock sequence with vehicles, containers, and a controlled rescue geography. Port access and stunt planning require production assessment.

NCCA Entertainment

Kelly R. Tenney, Founder

20+ years in film and television
Nine seasons as co-producer on One Tree Hill

Atlanta-based story development with a focus on character, audience, and production.

The opportunity

Seeking a lead attachment and producing partner

Partner with NCCA Entertainment to package PAPER TAGS for a Lifetime or BET+ development conversation.

Script available for review. Casting remains open.

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